the Gir sanctuary, were accorded the GI tag for the mangoes grown in the Gujarat districts of Junagadh and Amreli. The GI-tag helped prevent the sale of ordinary Kesar mangoes as 'Gir Kesar Mangoes' and immensely helped the farmers in the two districts to differentiate their produce and command a rightful price.



8. Nagpur Oranges

Nagpur orange is widely cultivated in the Vidarbha region (Nagpur and Amravati divisions) of Maharashtra and some parts of Madhya Pradesh. Over the years, consistent efforts have also been made to develop **Nagpur as an orange-growing cluster** to increase income of the orange cultivators in the region and provide them with market access. According to the Maharashtra State Agriculture Department **~40 lakh hectare land** is under orange cultivation in the Nagpur District. The **Department of Commerce, Ministry of Commerce and Industry** sees a great potential for export of these oranges in international market. For instance, under India's Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) with the UAE, exports of citrus fruits and other agricultural produce is going to see an upward trend as the bilateral now allows for a duty-free access of Indian exporters to the UAE market. They are also exported to other **Gulf countries and Canada, US, Germany, and UK**.

9. Basmati Rice

The Geographical Indication (GI) tag has played a pivotal role in catapulting **Basmati rice to the forefront of India's export success story**. India, being the leading producer and exporter of Basmati rice, owes its dominance to the abundance of production and diverse varieties found in the Himalayan region of the Indian subcontinent. The unique agroclimatic conditions of this region, coupled with the distinctive harvesting and processing methods inherent to local farming practices, imbue Basmati rice with its characteristic aroma and flavor. As a result, Basmati rice constitutes a substantial portion of India's rice exports. In the 2022-23 financial year, Basmati rice exports amounted to 45.61 lakh tons, contrasting with non-Basmati rice shipments totaling 177.92 lakh tons.



Preserving Heritage, Savoring Excellence: The Impact of Geographical Indication on Darjeeling Tea

Darjeeling Tea's distinctive flavor and exceptional quality owe much to the favorable geo-agro-climatic conditions, specific soil composition, and traditional cultivation techniques employed in the Darjeeling hills. Cultivated across 87 gardens at elevations reaching 2,000 meters, the **Tea Board of India** meticulously delineates the **Geographical Indication (GI) production** area.. Instances of tea **falsely labeled** as Darjeeling from countries like **Kenya and Nepal** underscore the need for stringent legal safeguards. **Consumer perceptions** further highlight the intrinsic value attached to Darjeeling Tea. According to surveys, **32 percent** of domestic consumers express a **very high appreciation** for Darjeeling tea, 56 percent have a high appreciation, and 12 percent have a moderate appreciation. Moreover, domestic consumers in India are **willing to pay significantly higher prices,** ranging from 25% to **300% more** for Darjeeling tea compared to Assam or Dooars tea. Despite these elevated prices, a staggering **92% of tea consumers** surveyed affirm their willingness to pay more for Darjeeling tea due to their preference for its taste, quality, and reputation. Interestingly, **consumer trust** primarily rests on the name "Darjeeling" and the reputation of the retailer, with little attention paid to GI logos or verification processes.

Application Process and Role of the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999

The **application process** for obtaining a GI tag involves a **detailed examination** of the unique qualities and characteristics of the product, directly attributable to its geographical origin. Applicants **must provide evidence** of the product's distinctiveness and its connection to the specific region. Government agencies, such as the **Geographical Indications Registry**, play a pivotal role in processing and examining GI applications. Additionally, various agricultural boards and organizations collaborate to support farmers in navigating the application process.

The **legal framework** governing Geographical Indications includes both international agreements and domestic legislation. Internationally, the Agreement on **Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS)** plays a pivotal role in providing a foundation for GI protection. In the Indian context, the **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999**, is the primary legislation. Enacted to comply with India's obligations under TRIPS, the GI Act establishes the legal framework for the registration and protection of geographical indications. It outlines the procedures for obtaining GI registration, the **rights conferred upon registered proprietors,** and the **penalties** for unauthorized use of GI-protected products.

